MARCH 2026

IS IT TRUMP'S MASTER PLAN?

An Analysis of Energy Politics and Global Power Dynamics

AUTHOR :
YAJVAN SAURI
Independent Research
2026

ABSTRACT

This paper examines the hypothesis that recent geopolitical actions by the United States toward major oil-producing nations may reflect a broader strategy aimed at securing global energy dominance. The analysis focuses on two key case studies: Venezuela and Iran, both of which possess some of the largest proven oil reserves in the world. Venezuela holds the largest reserves globally with more than 300 billion barrels, while Iran ranks among the top three with over 200 billion barrels of proven reserves.

The study explores whether U.S. interventions, economic policies, and strategic alliances are connected to control over these energy resources. It also compares the treatment of different nuclear states, highlighting how geopolitical responses may vary depending on strategic and economic interests. Additionally, the paper evaluates arguments that rising global oil prices and disruptions to energy supply routes could create economic advantages for major producers such as the United States.

Ultimately, the research investigates whether these patterns represent a coordinated geopolitical strategy—what some analysts describe as a potential "energy dominance" doctrine shaping modern U.S. foreign policy.

Key Points

- Oil resources strongly influence global geopolitics
- Venezuela and Iran hold some of the world's largest reserves
- Energy markets and international conflicts are often interconnected
- Control of energy supply can shape global economic power

INTRODUCTION

Oil has played a central role in global geopolitics for more than a century. Countries that possess large energy reserves often become strategically important in international relations because oil influences economic growth, military power, and global trade. Control over energy resources can shape alliances, conflicts, and political decisions made by powerful nations. As a result, regions with large oil reserves frequently attract the attention of global powers seeking to secure energy stability and economic advantage.

Two countries that hold major significance in this context are Venezuela and Iran. Venezuela possesses the largest proven oil reserves in the world, while Iran ranks among the top countries with substantial petroleum resources and a strategic location in the Middle East. Because of their energy wealth and geopolitical positions, both nations have been involved in complex political tensions with the United States over the past decades.

In recent years, some analysts and commentators have suggested that certain foreign policy actions may also be influenced by energy-related interests. According to this perspective, control over oil resources and supply routes could play a role in shaping geopolitical strategies. This paper explores these arguments by examining developments involving Venezuela and Iran and analyzing whether these events may indicate a broader strategy related to global energy influence.

CASE STUDY : VENEZUELA AND GLOBAL OIL POLITICS

Venezuela holds the largest proven oil reserves in the world, estimated at more than 300 billion barrels. Because of this enormous energy wealth, the country has long been a significant player in global oil markets. Oil production has historically formed the backbone of Venezuela's economy and has also influenced its political relations with other nations.

Over the past two decades, Venezuela has experienced political instability, economic crisis, and international tensions. The United States has imposed sanctions on Venezuela and has supported political changes within the country. Critics argue that these actions may be connected not only to political concerns but also to strategic interests related to energy resources and control of global oil supply.

Following political changes and economic restructuring, several international companies have increased their involvement in Venezuela's oil industry. As a result, Venezuela has become an important case study for examining how geopolitical strategies, economic interests, and energy resources can intersect in global politics.

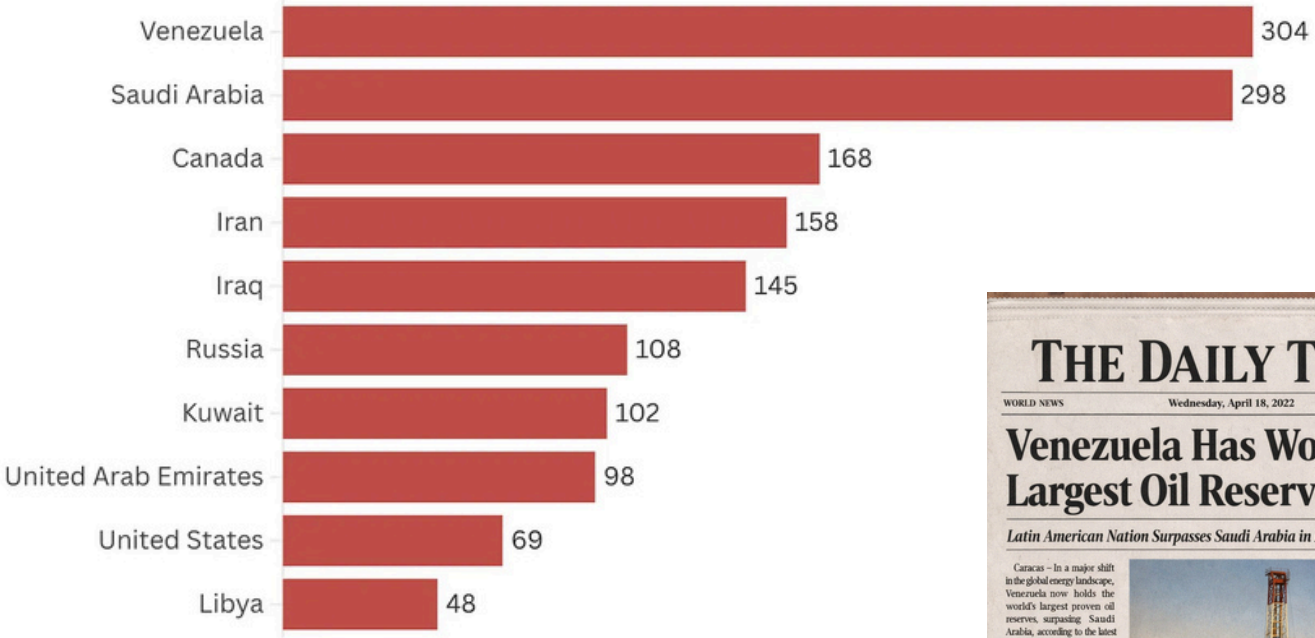
This example raises an important question: whether global powers sometimes pursue foreign policy actions partly to secure influence over strategic energy resources.

U.S. Policy Toward Venezuela

Petro-Imperialism Strategy: The U.S. is accused of using a strategy similar to those used in Iraq and Venezuela. In Iraq, the U.S. took control of oil reserves after the fall of Saddam Hussein; in Venezuela, American companies now control 60% of oil production. The goal in Iran is allegedly to overthrow the government to allow American companies to take over their oil fields.

Venezuela has the largest proved oil reserves

Proved oil reserves are those that are economically feasible to extract under current conditions. Reserves can change if new discoveries are made, or oil is consumed.



THE DAILY TIMES

WORLD NEWS Wednesday, April 18, 2022 Since 1895

Venezuela Has World's Largest Oil Reserves

Latin American Nation Surpasses Saudi Arabia in Proven Crude Reserves

Caracas – In a major shift in the global energy landscape, Venezuela now holds the world's largest proven oil reserves, surpassing Saudi Arabia, according to the latest report from the Energy Information Administration (EIA). With over 300 billion barrels of proven reserves, Venezuela now holds the top position in the world.

Experts say this development could reshape the geopolitics of the oil market as Venezuela's vast reserves position which the country as a key player in the global energy dominance sector. Analysts note that accessing these reserves remains challenging due to the country's ongoing economic and political crises.

OPEC Reactions to Venezuela's Rise

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Impact on Global Oil Prices

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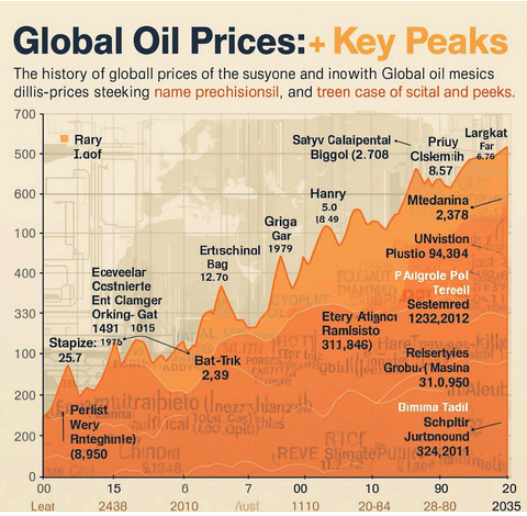
The North Korea Comparison: Experts point out that while North Korea possesses over 50 nuclear weapons and a harsh dictatorship like Iran, the U.S. does not attack them because they lack oil. In contrast, Iran holds the world's largest oil reserves, totaling 158 billion barrels valued at approximately $15 trillion, making it a primary target for energy security strategies.

If nuclear weapons were the only concern, North Korea would be the primary target; the focus on oil-rich Iran instead points toward a deeper geopolitical strategy centered on energy control.

ECONOMIC AND POLITICAL DIMENSIONS OF CONFLICT

One argument raised by analysts concerns the potential economic advantages that can emerge from rising global oil prices during geopolitical conflicts. The United States is currently one of the world's largest oil producers, producing roughly 13–14 million barrels of oil per day. When conflicts disrupt global supply chains or create instability in major oil-producing regions, international oil prices often increase significantly. Higher oil prices can provide economic benefits to major producers by increasing export revenues and expanding market opportunities in regions such as Europe and Asia. From this perspective, geopolitical tensions in oil-rich regions could indirectly influence global energy markets and economic gains for major energy producers.



Political Diversion and the "Wag the Dog" Argument

Another argument discussed by commentators involves the possibility of political diversion during times of domestic controversy. Some critics pointed to the timing of the U.S. military actions against Iran in early 2026, noting that they occurred shortly after the release of controversial files related to the **Jeffrey Epstein** case, which allegedly implicated several political and business figures. According to this interpretation, the sudden escalation of international conflict shifted media coverage and public attention away from the domestic scandal. This idea reflects what political scientists describe as the "Wag the Dog" effect, a situation in which foreign policy actions or military conflicts influence public discourse and media focus during politically sensitive moments. While this interpretation remains debated and difficult to prove conclusively, it illustrates how international conflicts can sometimes intersect with domestic political dynamics and public perception.

IS IT REALLY TRUMP'S MASTER PLAN?

The cases discussed in this report highlight how energy resources, geopolitical strategy, and global power dynamics are often closely connected. Countries with vast oil reserves, such as Venezuela and Iran, frequently become focal points of international political tension because control over energy supply can influence global markets and economic power. While official narratives surrounding these conflicts often emphasize security concerns, nuclear threats, or political stability, some analysts argue that strategic interests in oil resources may also play an important role.

From the author's perspective, the geopolitical tensions discussed in this report may be better understood as a broader strategic competition between the United States and countries such as Iran and Russia, rather than simply a regional conflict between Iran and Israel. The analysis presented suggests that nations possessing major oil reserves often become focal points of geopolitical pressure because control over energy resources can influence global economic and political power.
According to this perspective, political narratives such as supporting regime change or promoting freedom for the Iranian people may coexist with deeper strategic interests related to energy resources. By influencing political outcomes in oil-rich regions, global powers may gain greater access to or control over important energy supplies. Recent discussions surrounding global oil trade, including debates over countries purchasing Russian oil, further highlight how energy resources remain central to international political strategies.

In the modern geopolitical landscape, energy is not merely a resource — it is a strategic instrument of global power.

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